EPİSODE 001

PodCat English

"First Impressions Matter"

EPİSODE TOPİC

First Impressions & Introductions

Hosts: Tekir & Luna

Duration: 10 minutes

LİSTEN. LAUGH. LEARN.

Episode 001: "First Impressions Matter"

Episode Information

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- **Duration:** 10 minutes
- **Episode Topic:** First Impressions & Introductions

SEGMENT 1: INTRO & WELCOME (0:00-1:00)

TEKİR

Hey everyone! Welcome, welcome, welcome to PodCat English! I'm Tekir, and if you're here, you've already made a great decision. You're about to improve your English while actually having FUN. How cool is that?

LUNA

And I'm Luna! This is our very first episode, and we're so excited to have you here. Today, we're talking about something super important: first impressions.

TEKİR

Ah yes, first impressions! You know what they say: you never get a second chance to make a first impression.

LUNA

Exactly! And in English, how you introduce yourself can make a huge difference. Whether it's a job interview, meeting someone new, or just ordering coffee...

TEKİR

Your first words matter! So today, we're breaking it all down.

SEGMENT 2: THE TOPİC - FİRST IMPRESSİONS (1:00-3:30)

LUNA

Alright, let's start with the basics. Tekir, how do YOU usually introduce yourself in English?

TEKİR

Great question! So, it depends on the situation, right? If it's casual, I might just say: "Hey, I'm Tekir. Nice to meet you!" Simple, friendly, done.

LUNA

Perfect! That's casual and warm. But what if it's more formal? Like a job interview or a professional setting?

TEKİR

Then I'd say something like: "Hello, my name is Tekir. It's a pleasure to meet you." See the difference? "Nice to meet you" versus "It's a pleasure to meet you."

LUNA

Exactly! The vocabulary changes based on the context. And here's a pro tip for our listeners: always smile when you introduce yourself. Even if you're on the phone!

TEKİR

Oh, absolutely! People can HEAR a smile in your voice. It's like... you sound warmer, more approachable.

LUNA

Now, let's talk about some common mistakes. Tekir, what's the biggest mistake you see people make when introducing themselves?

TEKİR

Hmm, I'd say... overthinking it! People get SO nervous that they freeze up. Or they try to use fancy words they don't really understand.

LUNA

Yes! Keep it simple. If you're not sure about a word, don't use it. It's better to be simple and clear than complicated and confusing.

TEKİR

Another mistake? Not asking questions back! If someone says, "Hi, I'm John," don't just say "Hi" and stop there. Say, "Hi John, I'm Tekir. Where are you from?" or "What brings you here today?"

LUNA

Conversation is a two-way street. You give a little, you ask a little. That's how connections happen.

TEKİR

Exactly! And here's something interesting: in many cultures, when we meet someone new, people shake hands and make direct eye contact.

LUNA

Good point! In some cultures, like Japan, people bow instead of shaking hands. In some Middle Eastern countries, men might greet each other with a kiss on the cheek. It's fascinating how different cultures handle first meetings!

TEKİR

But in most English-speaking countries, a firm handshake and eye contact are usually the way to go. Not too weak, not too strong—just confident!

SEGMENT 3: USEFUL PHRASES (3:30-5:00)

LUNA

Okay, let's give our listeners some practical phrases they can use TODAY. Ready?

TEKİR

Let's do it!

For Casual Situations:

- "Hey, I'm [name]. Nice to meet you!"
- "What's your name?"
- "Where are you from?"

For Professional Situations:

- "Hello, my name is [name]. It's a pleasure to meet you."
- "May I ask what you do?"
- "I've heard great things about your work."

If You Didn't Catch Someone's Name:

- "I'm sorry, I didn't catch your name."
- "Could you repeat that, please?"

TEKİR

And if YOU have a difficult name, you can help them out. For example, I say: "I'm Tekir. It's spelled T-E-K-I-R."

LUNA

See? You're giving them something clear to work with. That's smart!

TEKİR

Pro tip: always have a little story ready about your name or where you're from. It makes you memorable!

LUNA

Love that. And remember, listeners: practice these phrases out loud. Don't just read them—actually SAY them!

SEGMENT 4: STREET INTERVİEW (5:00-6:30)

TEKİR

Alright, Luna, you know what time it is?

LUNA

Street interview time!

TEKİR

That's right! So we went out and asked people: "What's the most awkward first impression you've ever made?" And oh boy, the answers were GOOD.

LUNA

First person we talked to was Sarah from New York. Here's what she said:

TEKİR

"Oh my god, so I was at a job interview, and I was SO nervous. I went to shake the interviewer's hand, and I accidentally knocked over their coffee! It spilled everywhere! I wanted to die!"

LUNA

Oh no! But you know what? She actually got the job!

TEKİR

She did! Because she handled it well. She apologized immediately, helped clean up, and laughed about it. The interviewer said it showed she could handle pressure.

LUNA

See? Even mistakes can work in your favor if you handle them with grace and humor!

TEKİR

Next, we talked to Miguel from Spain. He told us:

LUNA

"I was meeting my girlfriend's parents for the first time. I wanted to compliment her mother's cooking, so I said: 'This chicken is very dead!' I meant 'well-done,' but I said 'dead'!"

TEKİR

(laughing) Oh man! That's both terrible and hilarious!

LUNA

But everyone laughed, and now it's a family joke. Sometimes the best first impressions are the funny ones!

SEGMENT 5: PHONE-IN SEGMENT (6:30-8:00)

TEKİR

Alright, now it's time for our phone-in segment! We don't have real calls yet—this is episode one!—but we've got questions from social media.

LUNA

Our first question comes from Ayşe in Istanbul. She asks: "I always get nervous and forget simple words when I meet native speakers. How can I fix this?"

TEKİR

Ayşe, I totally get it. I've been there! Here's what helps me: prepare a few sentences beforehand. Like, "Hi, I'm [name]. I'm from Turkey. I'm learning English." Just having those ready takes the pressure off.

LUNA

And remember: native speakers are usually very patient! If you forget a word, you can say: "Sorry, I forgot the word... how do you say..." and describe it. Most people will help you!

TEKİR

Also, practice! Talk to yourself in the mirror. I know it sounds weird, but it works. The more you practice introducing yourself, the more automatic it becomes.

LUNA

Great advice! Next question is from Carlos in Brazil: "Is it rude to ask someone to repeat their name if I didn't understand it?"

TEKİR

Not at all! It's actually MORE rude to pretend you heard it and then call them the wrong name later.

LUNA

Exactly! Just say: "I'm sorry, I didn't catch that. Could you say it again?" People appreciate the effort to get it right.

TEKİR

And if it's a really difficult name, you can even say: "I want to make sure I pronounce your name correctly. Can you say it one more time?" That shows respect!

SEGMENT 6: COMMUNİTY SHOUTOUT (8:00-9:00)

LUNA

Okay everyone, it's time for our VERY FIRST Community Shoutout!

TEKİR

Yes! So in our launch video, we asked you to share your funniest English mistakes. And WOW, you guys delivered!

LUNA

We got hundreds of comments! Thank you so much! We read every single one, and choosing just five was HARD.

TEKİR

But we did it! So here are our top 5 stories from this week:

LUNA

Number 5: @EnglishWithMaria said: "I went to a bakery and asked for 'soap' instead of 'soup.' The cashier looked so confused and handed me actual hand soap!"

TEKİR

(laughing) Oh no! That's not what you wanted for lunch!

LUNA

Number 4: @LearnerFromBrazil wrote: "I told my colleague 'I'm so boring today' when I meant 'I'm so bored today.' He just nodded and walked away!"

TEKİR

(laughing) Ouch! That's the difference between 'boring' and 'bored' - super important!

LUNA

Number 3: @PedroFromPorto said: "I wanted to compliment my friend's new haircut, so I said 'Your hair looks very cheap!' I meant 'chic'... not cheap!"

TEKİR

Oh man! That's the opposite of a compliment!

LUNA

Number 2: @SarahInSeoul shared: "I told my host family 'I'm full of food' instead of 'I'm full.' They thought I was calling myself fat!"

TEKİR

(laughing) Sometimes less is more! Just say 'I'm full' - perfect!

LUNA

And our NUMBER ONE story comes from @AlexFromPoland who said: "I was at a hotel and asked the receptionist 'Can I have a crap?' I meant 'Can I have a map?' The silence was deafening."

TEKİR

(laughing) The M and C confusion strikes again! Classic!

LUNA

Thank you to everyone who shared! Maria, LearnerFromBrazil, Pedro, Sarah, and Alex—you're all legends!

SEGMENT 7: NEXT WEEK'S CHALLENGE (9:00-9:30)

TEKİR

Alright, before we go, we've got NEXT week's challenge!

LUNA

Are you ready? Here it is:

TEKİR

Tell us about a time when you made a GREAT first impression in English. What did you say? What did you do? How did it feel?

LUNA

We want to hear your SUCCESS stories! Not just the funny mistakes—we want to celebrate your wins too!

TEKİR

Drop your story in the comments. Best 5 answers will be featured in next week's episode!

LUNA

And remember: it doesn't have to be something huge. Maybe you ordered coffee successfully, or had a great conversation with a stranger. Small wins count!

SEGMENT 8: OUTRO (9:30-10:00)

TEKİR

Well everyone, that's our first episode!

LUNA

Thank you SO much for being here with us. This is just the beginning!

TEKİR

If you enjoyed this, please hit that subscribe button. Turn on notifications so you never miss an episode.

LUNA

Leave a comment, tell us what you thought, share your challenge story!

TEKİR

And most importantly...

LUNA

Listen.

TEKİR

Laugh.

BOTH

Learn!

LUNA

I'm Luna...

TEKİR

And I'm Tekir...

BOTH

And we'll see you next time on PodCat English!

TEKİR

Keep speaking, keep learning, keep growing!

LUNA

Bye everyone!

Key Takeaways From This Episode

Casual Introductions:

- "Hey, I'm [name]. Nice to meet you!"
- "Where are you from?"
- "What brings you here?"

Professional Introductions:

- "Hello, my name is [name]. It's a pleasure to meet you."
- "May I ask what you do?"
- "I've heard great things about your work."

If You Didn't Catch Their Name:

- "I'm sorry, I didn't catch your name."
- "Could you repeat that, please?"

Pro Tips:

- Always smile when introducing yourself
- Keep it simple—don't overthink it
- Ask questions back—conversation is two-way
- A firm handshake + eye contact in English-speaking countries
- Have a story ready about your name
- Practice out loud!

Next Week's Challenge

Share your SUCCESS story!

Tell us about a time when you made a GREAT first impression in English. What did you say? What did you do? How did it feel?

Drop your story in the comments. Best 5 answers featured in Episode 002!

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